grouping. One can call it alignment; one can call it leaning, as Nehru did; or one can call it tilting. The book has described two instances when India tilted—toward the US in 1962 and the Soviet Union in 1971. In both instances, Indian policymakers tried to resist tilting until they had exhausted all other options. Tilting was the Indian leadership's last best option, but it was not a taboo. India tilted when five conditions were in place.

First, there was a clear and present imperative, and, second, India was unable to deal with it on its own. In the case of 1962, the threat was due to Indian reversals in the Sino-Indian war, with the fear of a larger Chinese invasion of India looming. During 1971, the tilt occurred in the midst of the Bangladesh crisis, with India and Pakistan facing off and the possibility of Chinese intervention on Pakistan's behalf.

Third, tilting occurred when the Indian inclination to diversify its dependence on multiple partners was thwarted and it could not deal with the threat on its own. In 1962, the Soviet Union refused to back India (or even stay neutral) against China at a critical stage in the war. The 1971 tilt occurred when India doubted the US would come to its aid if China intervened on behalf of Pakistan in the event of an India-Pakistan war.

Fourth, tilting occurred when there was a willing partner to tilt toward—just as it takes two to tango, it takes two to tilt. In 1962, the US was waiting with open arms. In 1971, the Soviet Union stood ready.

Fifth, the Indian leadership had to have sufficient political capacity to undertake a tilt. In 1962, Nehru had the political mandate and, indeed, there was sufficient support for asking the US for aid and signing an Air Defense Agreement. In 1971, Indira Gandhi, who had been re-elected with a clear and large political mandate, used her political capital (and the impending threat) to quell concerns about the Soviet treaty.

Diversification: Possibilities and Pitfalls

This book also helps uncover both the strengths and weaknesses of India's diversification strategy. On the one hand, diversification allowed Indian policymakers to seek benefits from multiple sources. Investing in multiple partnerships also gave Indian policymakers the ability to tilt when necessary. On the other hand, for a strategy that was designed to increase India's flexibility, diversification depended a great deal on the willingness